TIP You can also more easily layer on helper frameworks to minimal APIs, such as Carter (https://github.com/CarterCommunity/Carter), which can provide some structure and support functionality if you want it.

Overall, the choice is up to you whether web API controllers or minimal APIs are better for your application. Table 20.1 summarizes the questions and where you should favor one approach over the other, but the final choice is up to you!

Table 20.1 Choosing between minimal APIs with web API controllers

Question	Minimal APIs	Web API controllers
1. Do you need conneg?	Can't use conneg out of the box	Built-in and extensible
2. How critical is performance?	More performant than web API controllers	Less performant than minimal APIs
3. Complex filtering?	Have a simple, extensible filter pipeline	Have a complex, nonlinear, filter pipeline
4. Is this a new project?	Minimal APIs are getting many new features and are a focus of the ASP.NET Core team.	The MVC framework is receiving small new features, but is less of a focus.
5. Do you have experience with web API controllers?	Minimal APIs share many of the same concepts, but have subtle differences in model binding.	Web API controllers may be familiar to users of legacy ASP.NET or older ASP.NET Core versions.
6. Do you prefer convention over configuration?	Requires a lot of explicit configuration	Convention- and discovery-based, which can appear more magical when you're unfamiliar

That brings us to the end of this chapter on web APIs. In the next chapter we'll look at one of more advanced topics of MVC and Razor Pages: the filter pipeline and how you can use it to reduce duplication in your code. The